

Condition of Returned Items Policy

Official eBay Standards for Item Condition Upon Return, by Category (Real Policy Text)

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Source

This document reproduces eBay's official Condition of Returned Items Policy, retrieved from ebay.com (eBay Inc.). It is real, live platform policy text covering item condition requirements upon return.

1. Condition of Returns Policy Overview

Buyers may be liable for loss in value of an item if it's returned in a different condition from which it was received, or if the item is not packaged securely to prevent damage in shipment. In the event that an item is returned used or damaged, the seller might deduct the amount of loss from the buyer's refund. This applies when the loss in value is due to handling of the goods which was not necessary for checking the condition, properties, or mode of operation.

Items returned after inspection through eBay Authenticity Guarantee will be sent back to the buyer, and a refund will not be issued, if the item is returned in a different condition from which it was received. Buyers who have a history of abusing the returns process may be subject to consequences outlined in eBay's Abusive Buyer Policy.

2. General Return Requirements (Same or Unaltered Condition)

To be eligible for a full refund, the exact item purchased must be returned. Returns that do not meet the following criteria may be subject to a deduction from the refund to cover the loss in the item's value. This is not an exhaustive list:

- Unused, unaltered, with no damage or signs of use outside of the listed item condition or how it was received.
- All parts and accessories must be intact.
- Must be returned with original product packaging: boxes, UPCs, bags, or any items used to wrap and protect the item.
- Must include all items that were included in the original package, such as cords, cables, remote controls, manuals, warranty and rebate cards, free gifts, or bonus items.
- Items must have original tags, labels, and/or any accompanying materials that were originally included.

3. Category-Specific Condition Requirements

Art & Collectibles

- Must include any provided certificates of authenticity, grading, or appraisal.
- Items must not be removed from sealed packaging.

Business & Industrial

- Should be drained of any fuel or liquid.
- If assembled, item should be dismantled before return.

Fashion

- Items cannot appear washed or used.
- Items must have original manufacturer tags.
- Sanitary lining cannot be removed from an undergarment.
- Item cannot be altered in any way.
- Item cannot be stained (dirt, makeup, food, etc.).

Food & Beverages

- Item must be unopened.
- Item must not be expired.

Home & Garden

- Vacuum-sealed products must remain vacuum sealed.
- Should be drained of any fuel or liquid.
- If assembled, item should be dismantled before return.

Software, Movies, Music & Games

- Factory seal must not be broken/opened.

4. Enforcement

Activity on eBay is required to follow this policy, the eBay User Agreement, and all applicable laws, as well as respect the rights of third parties. If it doesn't, eBay may take action consistent with applicable laws and the User Agreement, and may even be legally required to do so. Such actions may include, as an example only: removing the listing or other content, issuing a warning, restricting activity, or account suspension.

5. Frequently Asked Questions (from official policy page)

I removed clothing tags, then decided the item was too small. Can I still get a full refund?

You can return the item if the seller accepts returns, but as it's no longer in the exact same condition as when received, the seller might deduct an amount from the refund to cover loss of value.

An item I sent back got damaged during return shipping. Can I still get a full refund?

If the item was damaged due to it being insufficiently packed and protected for shipping, the seller might deduct an amount from the refund for loss of value.

I returned an item immediately, unaltered, but the seller claims it's not in the same condition. What should I do?

The buyer can ask eBay to step in and help, per the eBay Money Back Guarantee policy.

A buyer returned an item damaged. What should a seller do?

If the seller qualifies to deduct an amount from the buyer's refund, they can deduct up to 50% from the refund for the loss in value of the item.

6. Why This Policy Exists

eBay states this policy exists to make eBay a fair place to sell. To make eBay a fair place to sell, eBay holds buyers to certain standards. When buyers do not follow these standards, eBay takes action on buyers and protects sellers.